Corporate Banking Conflicts of Interest Policy

Version 4.4. Effective January 1, 2025. Policy owner: Chief Financial Officer.

Purpose

The purpose of this document is to describe the controls, responsibilities and escalation paths that protect clients, employees and the firm. It is designed to be proportionate to the risks of the business while remaining practical for front-office and support functions. This policy sets out the minimum standards that apply across the division and supports the firm's obligations under applicable law and regulation.

Scope

Where local regulation is stricter than this policy, the local requirement prevails and must be documented in a country addendum. It covers activity conducted on firm premises, remotely, and while travelling on firm business. The policy applies to all permanent employees, contractors and consultants, including staff seconded from other legal entities of the group.

Definitions

Material change means any change that alters a limit, a threshold, an approval authority or the population to which the policy applies. Second line of defence refers to the independent Risk and Compliance functions that set standards and challenge the first line. Policy owner means the senior manager accountable for maintaining this document and for approving interpretations of it.

Policy Requirements

1. Outside business activities must be disclosed and approved within 14 days of the employee accepting the role. Evidence of compliance must be retained for audit.

Roles and Responsibilities

Employees must complete the associated mandatory training module within thirty days of joining and annually thereafter. Line managers are accountable for ensuring their teams understand and follow the policy, and for completing attestations on time.

Monitoring and Reporting

Exceptions, breaches and near misses are recorded in the operational risk system within five business days of identification. Key risk indicators linked to this policy are reported monthly to the divisional Risk Committee, with red-rated indicators escalated immediately.

Exceptions

All approved exceptions are recorded in the central exceptions register and reviewed quarterly by the policy owner. Exceptions must be requested in writing, include a risk assessment and a remediation plan, and are valid for no longer than twelve months.

Breaches

Breaches of this policy may lead to disciplinary action, up to and including termination of employment, and may be reported to regulators. Employees who identify a breach should report it promptly to their manager or to Compliance; good-faith reporting is protected.

Review

The policy owner reviews this document at least annually or following a material change in regulation, business model or risk profile. Material changes require approval by the divisional Risk Committee before publication.